

- (a) Japan (b) China
(c) India (d) Pakistan

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2009

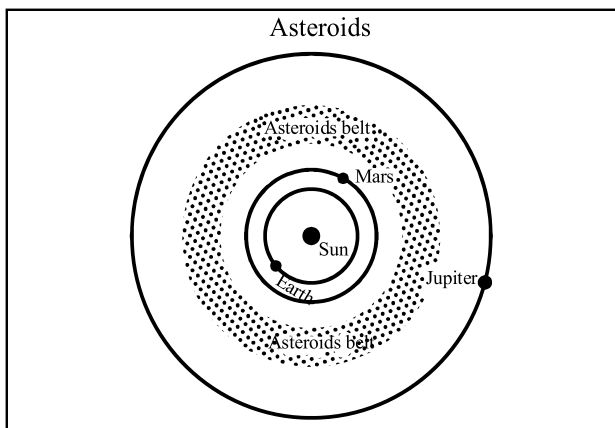
Ans. (a)

SELENE is also known as 'Kaguya' is an orbiter spacecraft sent to the orbit of the moon by Japan on 14 September, 2007. It revolved around the moon for approximately 1 year and 10 months successfully and after that, it fell upon the surface of the Moon at Gill Crater voluntarily.

xii. The Asteroids

*The group of small pieces of rock and metal revolving around the Sun between the orbits of Mars and Jupiter is called asteroids. *Asteroids, vary in size and some can be **1000 km** in diameter for example Ceres. *According to the position of these asteroids in space, they are categorized in the following way –

- Main belt** - In this belt, there are some prominent asteroids named Hungaria, Flora, Phocaea, Eos, Themis, Cybele, Hilda and Koronis.
- Near Earth Asteroids (NEAs)** - Among these Aten, Apollo, Amor and Atira are prominent ones.
- Trojans** - Near the Lagrange point of the planet Jupiter orbit.



- The group of small pieces of rock revolving round the sun between the orbits of Mars and Jupiter are called:
 - Meteors
 - Comets
 - Meteoroid
 - Asteroids

I.A.S. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (d)

The group of small pieces of rock revolving around the Sun between the orbits of Mars and Jupiter is called asteroids. Asteroids vary in size & some could be of 1000 km in diameter.

- Consider the following statements regarding asteroids :
 - Asteroids are rocky debris of varying sizes orbiting the Sun
 - Most of the asteroids are small but some have diameter as large and 1000 km
 - The orbit of asteroids lies between the orbits of Jupiter and Saturn
 [Of these statements] :
 - 1, 2 and 3 are correct
 - 2 and 3 are correct
 - 1 and 2 are correct
 - 1 and 3 are correct

I.A.S. (Pre) 1998

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

- The Asteroids are small celestial bodies in the solar system which are found between the planets
 - Mercury and Venus
 - Mars and Jupiter
 - Jupiter and Saturn
 - Neptune and Saturn

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

- What is the difference between asteroids and comets?
 - Asteroids are small rocky planetoids, while comets are formed of frozen gases held together by rocky and metallic material.
 - Asteroids are found mostly between the orbits of Jupiter and Mars, while comets are found mostly between Venus and Mercury.
 - Comets show a perceptible glowing tail, while asteroids do not.
 Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
 - 1 and 2
 - 1 and 3
 - 3 only
 - 1, 2 and 3

I.A.S. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (b)

Asteroids are generally considered to be made up of metals and rocky material, while comets are made up of ice, dust and rocky material. Asteroids are found much closer to the Sun. Comets are formed farther from the Sun in the 'Kuiper Belt' and Oort Cloud. Comets sprout tails when they approach the Sun. Asteroids typically remain much more solid and self-contained even when near the Sun.